The Hindu
EDITORIAL ANALYSIS

24th January 2025

PREPARE FOR BANK (PO/ CLERK), SSC,UPSC, State PSC, CAT,CTET,RAILWAY EXAMS,CDS, TET, NDA/AIRFORCE, NET and all Govt. Exams

VOCABULARY

1. Petulance (चिड़चिड़ापन)

Meaning: Irritable or childish behavior, especially when complaining about something trivial.
Synonyms: Irritability, peevishness, fretfulness
Antonyms: Patience, calmness, composure
Example: His petulance was evident when he threw a tantrum over a minor inconvenience.

2. Cascading (क्रमिक गिरावट)

Meaning: A process where something, typically information or effects, passes on successively to a series of levels.
Synonyms: Flowing, successive, sequential
Antonyms: Isolated, static, stagnant
Example: The scandal led to a cascading series of resignations within the organization.

VOCABULARY

3. Catastrophic (विनाशकारी)

Meaning: Involving or causing sudden great damage or suffering.
Synonyms: Disastrous, devastating, calamitous
Antonyms: Fortunate, beneficial, harmless
Example: The earthquake had a catastrophic impact on the local communities.

4. Scuppered (नष्ट करना)

Meaning: To prevent from working or succeeding; to sabotage.
Synonyms: Thwarted, wrecked, foiled
Antonyms: Aided, facilitated, supported
Example: The sudden change in regulations scuppered their plans to expand the business.

VOCABULARY

5. Flaccid (ढीला)

Meaning: Lacking firmness, resilience, or energy.
Synonyms: Limp, weak, slack
Antonyms: Firm, strong, taut
Example: The once vibrant plant became flaccid due to lack of water.

6. Qualm (संदेह)

Meaning: An uneasy feeling of doubt, worry, or fear, especially about one's conduct.
Synonyms: Misgiving, doubt, unease
Antonyms: Confidence, assurance, certainty
Example: She had no qualms about speaking her mind during the meeting.

VOCABULARY

7. Magnanimous (उदार)

Meaning: Generous or forgiving, especially toward a rival or less powerful person.
Synonyms: Generous, noble, kind-hearted
Antonyms: Selfish, petty, vindictive
Example: Despite losing the match, he was magnanimous in congratulating the winner.

8. Exigent (आपातकालीन)

Meaning: Requiring immediate action or attention; urgent.
Synonyms: Urgent, pressing, critical
Antonyms: Trivial, minor, unimportant
Example: The exigent situation demanded that the fire brigade arrive promptly.

VOCABULARY

9. Pacify (शांत करना)

Meaning: To calm or soothe someone; to bring peace.
Synonyms: Calm, appease, placate
Antonyms: Agitate, provoke, enrage
Example: The mother tried to pacify her crying baby with a lullaby.

10. Affable (मिलनसार)

Meaning: Friendly, easy to talk to, and approachable.
Synonyms: Amiable, genial, cordial
Antonyms: Unfriendly, aloof, rude
Example: His affable nature made him popular among his colleagues.

VOCABULARY

Phrasal Verbs:

1. Top off
Meaning: To complete or finish something by adding a final touch

2. Run out of
Meaning: To have no more of a particular item remaining

3. Dive into
Meaning: To begin something with enthusiasm and energy

4. Leave out
Meaning: To omit or exclude something

VOCABULARY

Idioms & Phrases

1. Be a far cry from

Meaning: to be completely different from something

2. Go belly up

Meaning: to fail completely

3. Hit the big time

Meaning: to become very successful or famous

VOCABULARY

4. Pull the plug

Meaning: prevent something from happening or continuing

5. Rags to riches

Meaning: a person who rises from poverty to wealth

Article for Reading

WHO is right: On the U.S. leaving the World Health Organization

President Donald Trump's decision to withdraw the United States from the World Health Organization (WHO), based on charges of bias, is stunningly short sighted, and deeply concerning to the global health community. Pundits are predicting that this move, if not withdrawn, or reconsidered, may well unleash the butterfly effect — a cascading set of unpredictable consequences arising from even the smallest of changes in a system. Soon after his inauguration, Mr. Trump wasted no time in announcing the beginning of the process of ending the U.S.'s membership of WHO. In language that smacked of petulance, Mr. Trump, as he signed his first batch of executive orders, declared: "The World Health [Organization] ripped us off." The U.S. will now leave the United Nations health agency in 12 months' time and stop all financial contributions to its work.

He accused the organisation of mishandling the COVID-19 pandemic, and of being partisan towards China, though the U.S. contributed more to its coffers. The move has not been entirely unexpected: during his previous term as U.S. President, he relentlessly criticised WHO for acting slow and being “owned and controlled by China”; in 2020 he initiated a move to halt funding to WHO, though it was scuppered as his term came to an end. Why is the withdrawal of the U.S. significant? For starters, Mr. Trump is right — the U.S., which is a founding member of WHO, is also its biggest financial backer, contributing around 18% of its overall funding. Withdrawal of these funds will seriously impact health programmes being implemented across the world, including interventions for HIV/AIDS, tuberculosis and the eradication of certain infectious diseases.

WHO is also involved in ensuring equity of access to life-saving drugs for people across the world, building stronger health systems, detecting and preventing disease outbreaks. If Mr. Trump could set his petulance aside, it would be clear that global health does not operate in silos, and neither a stern countenance nor physical boundaries can keep pathogens out of one's own geography. If any lessons have been learned at all from the COVID-19 pandemic, it is that no one is safe until everyone is safe, and that collaboration among nations, and open sharing of data and technology are essential to tackle pandemics. WHO has reached out to the U.S., hoping that it will reconsider its decision and engage once again with it. As fantastic as it may sound, medicine is no stranger to miracles of science, and the health community hopes one more will restore the U.S. back to WHO's fold.

Summary

President Donald Trump’s decision to withdraw the United States from the World Health Organization (WHO) has sparked widespread concern and criticism within the global health community. Citing accusations of bias and mishandling of the COVID-19 pandemic, Trump justified the move by alleging WHO's partisanship toward China. The U.S., as WHO's largest financial contributor, provides around 18% of its funding. Its withdrawal could severely impact global health programs, including efforts to combat HIV/AIDS, tuberculosis, and infectious diseases, as well as equitable access to life-saving medications and stronger health systems. The move reflects a disregard for the interconnectedness of global health, as exemplified by the COVID-19 pandemic. WHO has reached out in hopes of reversing this decision, with the health community expressing optimism for a reconsideration.

Tone:

The tone is critical and cautionary, highlighting the potential consequences of the U.S. withdrawal while advocating for collaborative global health efforts. It also incorporates a sense of urgency and faint optimism for a reversal of the decision.

Reading Comprehension

Based on the above passage, answer the following questions:

Question 1:
Why is the U.S.'s contribution to the WHO considered significant?

a) The U.S. is the only country funding WHO's global health programs.
b) The U.S. plays a minor role in WHO but is its most vocal supporter.
c) The U.S. contributes 18% of WHO's funding, which supports critical health programs worldwide.
d) The U.S. primarily funds its own domestic health initiatives through the WHO.
e) None of the above

Question 2:
What argument does the passage present against the U.S.'s withdrawal from the WHO?

a) The WHO is entirely independent of political influences.
b) The COVID-19 pandemic has shown the importance of global collaboration in health.
c) The WHO has sufficient funding even without U.S. contributions.
d) The withdrawal will primarily affect U.S. domestic health policies.
e) None of the above

Question 3:
What is the butterfly effect referred to in the context of the U.S.'s withdrawal from the WHO?

a) The cascading and unpredictable consequences of the withdrawal on global health systems.
b) The rapid containment of disease outbreaks due to independent U.S. health programs.
c) A positive chain reaction improving global health equity.
d) The reallocation of U.S. funding to more effective health organizations.
e) None of the above

Article for Skimming

India’s winding road to ‘#EndTB’

Last year, tuberculosis (TB) emerged, once again, as the leading infectious disease killer globally. The goals, i.e., End TB targets of 90% reduction in TB deaths, 80% reduction in new cases, and zero TB-affected families facing catastrophic costs by 2030, seem to be a distant dream. In 2018, India extended the highest level of political commitment for the cause by pledging to achieve End TB targets on an accelerated timeline by 2025. However, the COVID-19 pandemic was a huge pushback to the efforts. According to the World Health Organization's Global Tuberculosis Report 2024, India continues to lead in the global TB burden (26% of cases) and is also the hub for drug-resistant TB (DR-TB) and TB deaths. While ambitious policies and initiatives are rolled out from the national level, the ground reality in India needs to be better understood to translate them into effective interventions.

India's National Tuberculosis Elimination Programme (NTEP) clearly defines the high-risk or vulnerable groups that are at risk of contracting TB and developing adverse outcomes. Dr. Pavitra Mohan, paediatrician and founder of Basic Healthcare Services, a non-governmental organisation working in south Rajasthan, says, "We get around 1000 persons with TB in our clinics every year and many of them have severe lung damage owing to fine dust inhalation from mining and stone carving. They are at risk for TB due to contributory factors like silicosis, undernutrition, overcrowding, and uncontrolled co-morbidities like diabetes." Migrant workers also have an added disadvantage of poor access to health-care facilities. Dr. Mohan says, "They prefer to go back to their native place if they fall ill and hence it is not easy for the healthcare delivery system also to keep track of their treatment." While a lot of attention is being paid to tackling undernutrition among persons with TB (pwTB), a host of other contributory factors in each geography needs to be addressed, requiring multisectoral action.

TB is a curable disease with effective and free drugs from NTEP. A significant achievement for India is the treatment initiation in more than 95% of notified cases. This was possible, over the years, by establishing an exclusive procurement and supply chain system for the NTEP. However, in 2023, there was a country-wide break in the supply chain — it still continues in many parts. Shortage of key drugs in the centres, many of which are unavailable in the open market, left the beneficiaries and their families in a struggle. Nandita Venkatesan, data journalist and two-time TB survivor, says, “It takes many a mile for pwTB to reach the finishing line of treatment combating a wide range of side effects. Shortage of such critical medicines disrupts the treatment, risking resistance to antibiotics and poor disease outcomes. Moreover, having to buy drugs from outside leads to catastrophic health expenses.”

Question 4:
Why are migrant workers particularly vulnerable to TB, according to the passage?

a) They work in industries with high TB risk like mining and stone carving.
b) They face barriers in accessing consistent healthcare and treatment tracking.
c) Their diets make them more susceptible to undernutrition.
d) They are predominantly exposed to overcrowded living conditions.
e) None of the above

Question 5:
Which of the following statements best summarizes the main argument of the passage?

a) India’s TB elimination efforts are hindered by a lack of national-level policies.
b) Migrant workers are the primary contributors to India’s high TB burden.
c) Drug shortages and social vulnerabilities threaten India’s progress towards End TB targets.
d) India’s TB elimination program has successfully eradicated undernutrition-related TB cases.
e) None of the above

Today's Descriptive Question:

Original Text:

Deglobalization refers to the process of reducing economic, political, and cultural interdependence among nations, often marked by a retreat from globalization. This shift involves nations prioritizing domestic industries, imposing trade barriers, and reducing reliance on international markets. While globalization emphasizes interconnectedness and open markets, deglobalization focuses on national self-sufficiency and regionalization. Several factors have contributed to the rise of deglobalization in recent years. Economic disparities caused by globalization, such as unequal wealth

distribution and job losses in certain sectors, have fueled discontent. Political movements advocating protectionism and nationalism have gained traction, leading to policies that prioritize local industries over global trade. Events such as trade wars, supply chain disruptions during the COVID-19 pandemic, and geopolitical tensions have further underscored the vulnerabilities of overreliance on global networks. Deglobalization can bring both benefits and challenges. On the positive side, it allows nations to bolster local industries, create jobs domestically, and reduce exposure to external economic shocks. It also encourages regional trade agreements and diversification of supply chains, reducing dependency on any single country. However, deglobalization can also lead to higher costs for goods, reduced innovation, and limited access to international markets. Smaller nations heavily reliant on exports may face economic stagnation, and global cooperation on issues like climate change may be hindered. While deglobalization signals a shift toward local priorities, it underscores the need for balanced policies that address domestic concerns without undermining global progress and interconnectedness.

Precis:

Deglobalization is the process of reducing global interdependence by prioritizing domestic industries, imposing trade barriers, and emphasizing self-sufficiency. It has emerged due to economic disparities, protectionist policies, and global disruptions like trade wars and the COVID-19 pandemic.

This shift offers benefits, such as strengthening local industries, creating jobs, and diversifying supply chains. However, it also poses challenges, including higher costs, reduced innovation, and limited global cooperation. While deglobalization focuses on local priorities, balanced strategies are crucial to addressing domestic needs without hindering global progress.

- **You recently purchased a product from an online store, but it was defective upon delivery. Write a formal email to the customer service department requesting a replacement or refund.**

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Subject: Request for Replacement or Refund of Defective Product

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Given the condition of the product, I kindly request either a replacement or a refund for this purchase. I would appreciate it if you could guide me through the necessary steps for returning the defective item and processing the replacement or refund.

Please let me know if any further information or documentation is required from my end to expedite the resolution of this matter.

Thank you for your prompt attention to this issue. I look forward to your response.

Sincerely,
[Your Name]

Match the column

1. Be a far cry from	A. to fail completely
2. Go belly up	B. prevent something from happening
3. Hit the big time	C. to become very successful or famous
4. Pull the plug	D. a person who rises from poverty to wealth
5. Rags to riches	E. to be completely different from something

Answer:

1-e

2-a

3-c

4-b

5-d

Vocabulary

1. Petulance:
2. Cascading:
3. Catastrophic:
4. Scuppered:
5. Flaccid:
6. Qualm:
7. Magnanimous:
8. Exigent:
9. Pacify:
10. Affable:

Rc ans

1.

Ans: c

Explanation:

The passage specifies that the U.S. is WHO’s largest financial backer, contributing about 18% of its funding, which supports health initiatives like disease prevention, equitable drug access, and system strengthening.

Why Other Options Are Incorrect:

a) Other countries also contribute to WHO’s funding.
b) The U.S. plays a major financial, not minor, role.
d) The funding is directed at global programs, not just domestic initiatives.

2.

Ans: b

Explanation:

The passage emphasizes that lessons from COVID-19 underscore the need for collaboration, shared data, and technology to tackle pandemics, which is undermined by the U.S. withdrawal.

Why Other Options Are Incorrect:

a) The passage notes accusations of bias, implying some political influence.
c) The withdrawal of U.S. funds will severely impact WHO programs.
d) The focus is on global, not domestic, health impacts.

3.

Ans: a

Explanation:

The passage suggests that the withdrawal could lead to a "butterfly effect," where even small changes, like the removal of U.S. funding, could lead to unpredictable and wide-ranging consequences for global health.

Why Other Options Are Incorrect:

b) The U.S.’s withdrawal is likely to weaken, not strengthen, health programs.
c) The butterfly effect here is negative, not positive.
d) The passage does not mention reallocating U.S. funding.

4.

Ans: b

Explanation:

The passage states that migrant workers often return to their native places when ill, making it difficult for the healthcare system to track and ensure continuity of their TB treatment.

Why Other Options Are Incorrect:

a) Mining and stone carving are linked to silicosis and TB but are not explicitly associated with migrant workers in the passage.

c) Undernutrition is a factor but is not the specific vulnerability highlighted for migrant workers.

d) Overcrowded living conditions are a general risk factor but not the primary challenge mentioned for this group.

5.

Ans: c

Explanation:

The passage emphasizes how drug shortages and factors like undernutrition, silicosis, and treatment access issues among vulnerable groups (e.g., migrant workers) hinder India's efforts to meet its ambitious TB elimination goals.

Why Other Options Are Incorrect:

a) Policies are not the issue; implementation and supply chain disruptions are.
b) Migrant workers are a vulnerable group but not the sole contributors.
d) Undernutrition-related TB cases are a focus, but eradication has not been achieved.

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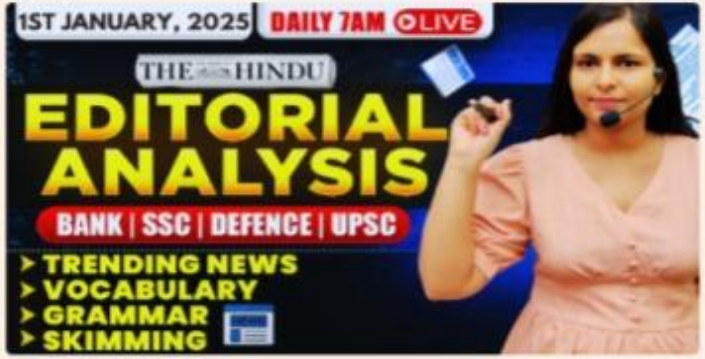

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